Organski[21] stated that collective security is not a scheme to keep some nations in check and not others. Rather, it is a plan by which any nation that uses force illegally is defeated. Organski underlined the five basic assumptions of collective security:

1. In any armed combat, all nations will agree on which combatant is the aggressor.
2. All nations are equally interested in restraining aggression from whatever source it comes.
3. All nations are equally free and able to join in action against the aggressor.
4. The combined power of the collectivity will be great enough to defeat the aggressor.
5. Knowing that overwhelming power stands ready to be used against it, an aggressor nation will either sheathe its sword or go down in defeat.

Morgenthau[22] highlights three basic conditions that must be fulfilled for the successful operation of collective security as a device to prevent war:

1. The collective security system must be able to gather, at all times, such overwhelming strength against any potential aggressor or coalition of aggressors that the latter would not dare to challenge the order defended by the collective system.
2. At least those nations whose combined strength would meet the requirements under the first principle must have the same conception of security which they are supposed to defend.
3. Those nations must be willing to subordinate their conflicting political interests to the common good defined in terms of the collective defence of all member states.

Under the League of Nations, the sanctions against Italy following the Italo–Ethiopia War in 1935–1936 and the United Nations intervention, in defence of the territorial integrity of South Korea, following an invasion from North Korea in 1950 and 1953, are examples of application of the principle of collective security.

The League of Nations failed drastically to implement the provisions of collective security as contained in Article 16 of the Covenant of the